

# Family Protocol Question Set

Prompts for families beginning to define shared rules, expectations, and forums.

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## Ownership

Who can own shares, under what conditions, and through which structures?

What information should owners receive to act responsibly?

How are dividends, reinvestment, liquidity, and long-term stewardship discussed?

What happens when an owner wants to exit or transfer ownership?

## Family Employment

What education or outside experience is expected before joining the business?

Who evaluates family members in management roles?

How are compensation, promotion, performance, and exit handled?

What roles exist for family members who choose not to work in the company?

## Governance Forums

Which topics belong to the family council, owner forum, board, and management team?

How often should each forum meet?

What decisions require consensus, majority agreement, or recommendation only?

How are conflicts escalated before they become personal or public?

## Culture and Continuity

What values must remain visible as the family and business grow?

How will the next generation learn the family history, responsibilities, and expectations?

What should the family never sacrifice for growth?

Confidential preparation resource. Not legal, tax, or investment advice.

How will the protocol be reviewed so it stays alive rather than becoming a document no one uses?